



KNOW HOW



Q I have an old Fedora installation. Everything is working fine but I am unable to use yum. For example, when I run:

```
# yum install exaile
```

...I get the following error messages:

```
Loaded plugins: fastestmirror
No plugin match for: fastestmirror
Determining fastest mirrors
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "/usr/bin/yum", line 29, in ?
    yummain.user_main(sys.argv[1:], exit_code=True)
  File "/usr/share/yum-cli/yummain.py", line 229, in user_main
    errcode = main(args)
  File "/usr/share/yum-cli/yummain.py", line 104, in main
    result, resultmsgs = base.doCommands()
  File "/usr/share/yum-cli/cli.py", line 339, in doCommands
    self._getTs(needsToRemove)
<snipped>
thread.error: can't start new thread
```

I'm unable to decipher what these crippled messages are supposed

to mean. Would you happen to have a clue?

—Nordon Lama, Sikkim

Well, it looks like the fastestmirror plug-in is the culprit that's not allowing you to use yum. Try to install Exaile by disabling the fastestmirror plug-in as follows:

```
# yum --disableplugin=fastestmirror install exaile
```

If even this does not work, then try the following two commands to clean the package cache and metadata (following which, try to install Exaile again):

```
#yum clean dbcache
#yum clean metadata
```

Hope this works out.

Q I have installed openSUSE 11.2 on my laptop. I tried installing Adobe Flash through Firefox, but could not succeed. As recommended, I tried installing it manually by downloading the RPM package from the Adobe website. Although the installation went fine and there were no error messages, Flash still does not work on my Firefox. Can you please help me?

—Gaurav Goswami, New Delhi

Since you've already installed the RPM package, just run the following command as the root user:

```
ln -s /usr/lib/libflash.so /usr/lib/web-browser/libflash.so
```

This should make your browser play all Flash content.

Q I have a website with Wordpress installed on a CentOS server. The installation is running fine except that Wordpress isn't generating thumbnails from uploaded images. Please help me resolve the issue.

—Amit Chawla, Mohali

Wordpress, by default, generates thumbnails using the GD library of PHP. Please check your PHP installation for GD support. If *php-gd* is not installed, then install it:

```
# yum install php-gd
```

After installing it, just run the following command to check whether the support is installed or not:

```
# php -m
```

The output list should include 'gd' in it. This should resolve the thumbnail issue with Wordpress.

Q I intend to set up a blog site within the company intranet to exchange news on the grapevine. Please do help me with instructions on how to go about it. I have a DNS on Fedora 6 and an ADS on a Win 2003 server.

—M. Shiva Prakash, by e-mail

There are several open source software that can be installed on Fedora to run a blog site. I would recommend you install Wordpress, as it is popular, user-friendly and easy to install. Install Apache, MySQL and PHP on your Fedora box. If they're not already installed, as these are required to install and run Wordpress. You can get complete help on installation at http://codex.wordpress.org/Installing_WordPress. 